



Lean Project Charter

Seattle Aquarium – Group Registration Process

This charter defines the scope and boundaries of your Lean Project.

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Subject Matter Experts (SME's): Misa Pang and Brianna Klein
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Process Overview

Group registration at the Seattle Aquarium varies by organization type and seasonal demand. Spring is the busiest season, so registration for spring visits should ideally open in the fall.

- **External groups** such as schools, corporations, and homeschool families register through the “**You Can Book Me**” tool on the Aquarium’s website.
 - Displays daily availability and class schedules
 - Users complete a registration form
 - Submitted forms are sent directly to the Aquarium Registrar
- **Internal Aquarium Team** (e.g., works with [Connections Partners](#))
 - **Connections Partners** are external organizations—such as community centers, nonprofits, and YMCAs—that have applied for and have been accepted into a special access program. While these groups are external, they participate through a program managed by an **internal Aquarium team**. Registration for Connections Partners is coordinated through:
 - **Email communication** with the internal Connections team
 - A **dedicated registration link** (typically shared via email or partner portal—source to be confirmed)
 - The internal team facilitates ongoing communication, scheduling, and support for these partners, ensuring alignment with broader registration systems and program goals.
- All customers use **ACME** for **tickets and payments**.
- **Daily Visits** are tracked on an **Excel** sheet (shows info from “**You Can Book Me**”). Connection Partners also use this form for information from **Raiser’s Edge**.
- Visitors are able to attend classes when they visit. **Classes and availability** are tracked on an **Excel** sheet.
- Most **email correspondence** occurs for rescheduling and follow-up communication.

Sub-Processes

The scholarship and bus reimbursement processes are in-scope. Determining the criteria for them is out of scope.

- **Scholarships Process** - Teachers can apply for Scholarships via a dedicated form (eligibility based on specific qualifying criteria)
- **Bus Reimbursement Process** – Eligible groups may submit a request for transportation reimbursement (up to \$500 per bus) via **DocuSign** Form. *(Note: this happens after the field trip has taken place.)*

Note: See the Detailed Registration Process Breakdown on the last two pages of the charter.

What does success look like? (Problem/Mission Statement)

- **Streamlined** processes across groups
- **Person-focused** and job satisfaction for the team
- **Manageable**, the Registrar position is not overwhelmed/burnt out during the peak system
- **Efficient**, the Registrar can efficiently schedule the volume of sign-ups
- **Centralized**, information about the sign-up process and registrations is all accessible in one place (multiple parties can access and monitor throughout process)

Challenges or Risks

- **Staff capacity** was recently reduced in size and organization is now working to rebuild or function on less
- Possible transition to a **new registration platform** (schools) may have the potential to impact the overall process
- **Connection Partners** also use registrar process (may need to consider impacts) but with potentially different tools
- **Cross Department systems** and teams overlap is unknown
- **Different groups** require different things

Scope and Boundaries (SIPOC)

Who starts the process?	• School (Teachers/Admins) - via public webpage • Corporate Groups - via public webpage • Home-School Families - via public webpage • Connections Partners – through established relationship with aquarium via email or a link • Ad-hoc Groups - via emails or phone inquiries
What are the key inputs?	• Online registration form (webpage submission)
High-Level Process Steps/Phases	1. Submit completed registration form online 2. Select preferred visit dates and times 3. Receive a confirmation email with schedule details (dates/times) 4. Closer to visit date: receive a follow-up email with logistics and reminders 5. After the visit: receive feedback request email
Subprocess (<i>occurs during or after the main flow</i>)	• Scholarship Program Process (during registration) • Accessibility/Accommodation Request Process - (during registration) • Bus Reimbursement Process (after visit; separate process via DocuSign)

What are the outputs?	Confirmed date and time for self-guided visit
Who are the customers?	- School Teachers/Admins - Corporate Groups - Home-School Families - Connections Partners - Ad-hoc Groups
Process Partners	- Registrar - Guest Services Team (Acme ticketing system) - Connections Coordinator - Corporate Groups Team
Stakeholders (Impacted Groups)	- Visitor Engagement Team (floor staff) - Volunteers - Aquarium Educators (on-site classes and support)
Technology/Systems Used	"You Can Book Me" – Booking interface Acme – Tickets and payments interface Daily Visit Log (Excel) – Internal tracking Class Tracker (Excel) – Education program tracking Email – Communication Raiser's Edge – Donor tracking (used by Connections Team) DocuSign – Bus reimbursement processing
Out of Scope	- Group greetings – Who greets the group when they arrive? - Scholarship program administration details (criteria) - Volunteer staffing - Accommodation processing - Subprocess: Bus reimbursements (processing of payment phase)

1-Day Workshop Recommended Focus

Workshop Duration:

- **Total Timeslot:** 9 hours
- **Facilitation Time:** 6 hours
- **Additional Time:**
 - 1 hour setup/prep
 - 1 hour lunch
 - 1 hour breakdown/close

High-Level Workshop Approach:

- **Measure** – Map current state & gather relevant data
- **Analyze** – Identify and discuss key challenges

- **Improve** – Generate ideas and potential solutions
- **Control** – Define future-state workflows and develop an action plan

Process Priority – To ensure sufficient time to complete the above approach, focus first on:

1. **External Groups Process** – website registration, assuming this is the larger portion of registrations.

Time-Permitting Prioritization from Seattle Aquarium:

2. **Accommodation/Accessibility Process**
 - a. Requests and coordination during registration
3. **Scholarship Program Process**
 - a. Eligibility and form submission during registration
4. **Connections Partners Process**
 - a. Registration via email or link
 - b. Data tracked in Raiser's Edge
5. **Bus Reimbursement Process**
 - a. Post-visit submission via DocuSign
 - b. Reimbursement processing

Data Requested that can help us prepare for facilitation

- **Registration Duration**
 - On average, how long does it take to complete all five steps/phases of the registration process (from initial inquiry to post-visit follow-up)?
 - Please share a typical time range if exact timing varies.
Response: Detailed Registration Process Breakdown and Estimates
- **Email Volume**
 - Approximately how many emails are exchanged with a single group during the registration process?
Response:
 1. *Paid visit (5-8 or more?)*
 - a) **5 emails-** request received, confirmation, order summary, reminder, post-visit survey
 - i) *If a reschedule is requested: 8 if the new date works. Add reschedule request received, reschedule confirmed, updated order summary*
 1. *If it does not work, repeat ^^ until it does*
 2. *Scholarship*
 - a) *For free admission: 6 emails to the lead teacher + 1 email to the administrator if they complete before any reminders are sent (7 emails). 7+ emails to the lead teacher and 2+ emails to the admin depending on how long it takes to complete (first after 10 days, then every 2 weeks) [9 total emails or more]*
 - b) *For bus reimbursement: 7 emails to the lead teacher + 1 email to the admin (8). Same reminder rules apply and these often take longer, so almost certainly there will be reminders [11 emails total or more]*
 3. *Including literally any questions at all makes the value increase by at least 2*
- **Registration Demand**

- How many group registrations do you typically process per **month** or **season**?
- If possible, please break this down by group type (e.g., schools, corporate, homeschool, Connections Partners).

Response: For an estimation on how many groups our registrar coordinates with, there were

- **January to June in 2025:**
 - **163 school groups** (76 school groups in Jan-April, 87 school groups from May to June)
 - **12 connections groups from**

Team Members

Role	Name	Notes
Registrar	Emily Fogarty	
School and Public Programs Coordinator	Manjari Misra	
Director of Guest Experience	Henry Cabrera	
School and Public Programs Supervisor	Paul Decker	
Community Outreach Coordinator	Brianna Klein	
Senior Educator	Sofia Cano	Frequently works with customer emails
Lead Marine Science Interpretive Diver	Greg Palmerino	
Volunteer Engagement Specialist	Shae Guinee	
VP of Conservation, Engagement, & Learning	Darcie Larson	Project Sponsor
Grants and Admin Specialist	Meagan Ashton	

Workshop Deliverables

Following our facilitation, you'll receive a comprehensive set of materials to support continued alignment and action:

- **Current State Process Map** - A visual representation of your existing workflow, highlighting key steps, bottlenecks, and opportunities.

- **Future State Map** - A co-created vision of your optimized process, aligned with strategic goals and stakeholder input.
- **90-Day Action Plan** - A prioritized roadmap of next steps, including owners, timelines, and success indicators to drive momentum.
- **Workshop Summary & Visual Highlights** - A recap of key insights, decisions, and moments from the session—complete with photos, quotes, and visual documentation to support storytelling and internal sharing.

Workshop Roles and Responsibilities

To ensure a successful workshop and sustained follow-through, each role plays a vital part in shaping outcomes and driving change:

Executive Sponsor & Business Sponsor

- **Engage** in key touchpoints: charter meetings, kickoff, mid-point review, final report-out, and 30/60/90-day check-ins. *As a general rule, Sponsors don't join the full workshop. This helps the team think freely, explore boldly, and work without unintentionally bumping into leadership boundaries.*
- **Collaborate** with the Project Lead to foster cross-division alignment and remove barriers.
- **Communicate** with impacted groups and champion the initiative among leadership peers.
- **Commit** necessary resources to support the workshop and implementation efforts.
- **Support** piloting of team-identified improvements and review out-of-scope ideas (parking lot items).
- **Celebrate** both learning and success—recognize the team's contributions and progress.

Project Lead

- **Participate** fully in the workshop and final report-out.
- **Lead** the team through execution of the 90-day action plan.
- **Communicate** regularly with the Sponsor and impacted groups, surfacing needs and potential roadblocks.
- **Review** out-of-scope ideas with the Sponsor for future consideration.
- **Celebrate** team achievements and foster a culture of learning and recognition.

Team Members

- **Engage** in the full workshop experience and contribute to the report-out.
- **Implement** the action plan collaboratively.
- **Celebrate** progress and learning throughout the journey.

Subject Matter Experts (As Needed)

- **Participate** in interviews and provide relevant insights.
- **Share** context, data, and expertise to inform decisions.
- **Engage** as needed to support clarity and alignment.

Detailed Registration Process Breakdown and Estimates

1. Before any field trips are requested (each of these steps takes a decent chunk of time depending on how many changes are being made from previous years; not estimated is the time it takes for MarComm to make updates once submitted)-
 - a. Create tracking documents for the year (Daily Visit Log, Classes Tracker)
 - b. Add availability to Outlook and Google Calendar (check Momentus for conflicts) (2-3 hours to complete probably)
 - c. Update communications (templates, automatic emails, scholarship forms) (a few hours for each document)
 - d. Update websites (ACME, YCBM, seattleaquarium.org) (5-6 hours estimates)
 - e. Update teacher resources (chaperone maps, Code of Conduct, etc.) (5-6 hours estimated)
2. Self-guided visit
 - a. New visit request received by Outlook notification
 - i) Check DVL to see if date/time works
 1. Review request for any other information that could influence confirmation (Code of Conduct warnings, accessibility requests, chaperone ratio, size of group, method of payment, other special requests)
 - b. If yes, send acceptance through YCBM
 - i) Mark email as complete and file
 1. Potential additional steps: replying for clarification or additional information, placing room holds for quiet spaces, requesting details for interpreters, adding links to requested resources, sending CoC DocuSign
 - c. Create entry in ACME
 - i) Save order # to YCBM listing
 1. Send confirmation email by forwarding to Registration first
 - d. Create entry in DVL
 - i) If scholarship group, send scholarship application
 - e. If doesn't work, edit decline response template to let them know why we had to reject and send either a rejection or possibly offer alternatives
 - f. Other maintenance as required leading up to day of visit (2 week reminder sent automatically by YCBM)
 - i) If scholarship group, send bus reimbursement scholarship 2-3 days after visit has ended (post-visit survey sent automatically by YCBM)
3. On-site class
 - a. New visit request received by Outlook notification
 - i) Check DVL and Classes Tracker to see if date/time works
 1. Review request for any other information that could influence confirmation (Code of Conduct warnings, accessibility requests, chaperone ratio, size of group, method of payment, other special requests)
 - b. If yes, send acceptance thru YCBM
 - i) Mark email as complete and file
 1. Potential additional steps: replying for clarification or additional information, placing room holds for quiet spaces, requesting details for interpreters, adding links to requested resources, sending CoC DocuSign

- c. Create entry in ACME
 - i) Save order # to YCBM listing
 - ii) Send confirmation email by forwarding to Registration first
- d. Create entry in DVL
 - i) If scholarship group, send scholarship application
 - ii) Create entry in Classes Tracker
- e. Update Outlook hold with program information
 - i) Reserve any necessary resources (orca skeletons, Momentus notice for plankton tows)
- f. If doesn't work, edit decline response template to let them know why we had to reject and send either a rejection or possibly offer alternatives
- g. Other maintenance as required leading up to day of visit (2 week reminder sent automatically by YCBM)
 - i) If scholarship group, send bus reimbursement scholarship 2-3 days after visit has ended (post-visit survey sent automatically by YCBM)